

THE TATTVAYOGABINDU OF RĀMACANDRA

Critical Edition and Annotated Translation of an Early
Modern Text on Rājayoga, with a Comparative Analysis of
the Complex Yoga Taxonomies from the Same Period



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Chapter I

Introduction

THE following section covers essential text-critical formalities. Following a description of the consulted and unconsulted witnesses, the title is discussed. This is particularly relevant in the case of Rāmacandra's text, where an unusual situation arises: the text is known by at least eleven different titles according to the final rubrics, colophons,¹ title pages, library cards, the printed edition, and citations. Thus, this phenomenon requires further discussion. Subsequently, the source texts, testimonia and parallels are briefly described and contextualised. Next, I will present a stemmatic analysis, discuss the text's stylistic peculiarities, and outline the conventions used in the critical edition.

¹Once more I would like to stress that in order to avoid terminological confusion, I consistently follow Camillo Formigatti's usage in distinguishing between the final rubric—the string of words marking the end of a textual unit, often including an assertion of authorship and title—and the colophon proper of a manuscript, that is, the statement providing information on the date, place, agency, or purpose of the manuscript's production. See Formigatti, 2022: 48–49.

Chapter 2

The *Tattvayogabindu* of

Rāmacandra

Critical Edition & Annotated
Translation

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3.1 Figures



Figure 2: The *dehasvarūpa* of *ajapāgāyatrī*. The image, reminiscent of a hippogriff, is part of an illustrated Sanskrit manuscript written in the Śāradā script. Preserved as a single large scroll under Acc. No. 1334 at the Oriental Institute in Srinagar (Kashmir), it is entitled *Nāḍīcakra*. The manuscript contains a depiction of the yogic body's *cakras* and *nāḍīs*. The text surrounding the figure closely corresponds to the additional material found in manuscript U₂ of the *Tattvayogabindu*. The manuscript reads (diplomatic transcription): *om daśame pūrṇagiripīṭhe lalāṭamaṇḍale candro devatā amṛtāsaktiḥ paramātmā ṛṣiḥ dvāvīṃśaddalāni amṛtavāsinikalā 4: ambikā 1 lambikā 2 gha(m)ṭkā 3 tālikā 4 dehasvarūpaṃ kākamukhaṃ 1 naranetraṃ 2 gośṛṅgaṃ 3 lalāṭabrahmapara 4 hayagrīvā 5 mayūramuśchaṃ 6 haṃsacārītāni 7 sthāna.*



Figure 3: Viṣṇu Viśvarūpa, India, Rajasthan, Jaipur, ca. 1800–1820, Opaque watercolor and gold on paper, 38.5 × 28 cm, Victoria and Albert Museum, London, Given by Mrs. Gerald Clark.



Figure 4: The Equivalence of Self and Universe (detail), folio 6 from the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* (Bulaki), India, Rajasthan, Jodhpur, 1824 (Samvat 1881), 122 x 46 cm, RJS 2378, Mehragarh Museum Trust.

Chapter 4

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